

Impatient surfers

Four of five viewers leave a stream if it rebuffers according to a study carried out by Tubemogul, a video distribution and analytics startup

CES 2010

Over 2700 technology companies expected to take part in the International Consumer Electronics Show (CES) in Las Vegas in January 2010

Amkette WF-301

A dual function device — keyboard with a trackball

Desktop users can enjoy the flexibility provided by the Amkette WF 301, which is an integrated wireless keyboard with a trackball that packs in the dual functionality of a keyboard and a mouse.

The keyboard can be used at a distance of up to 10 metres, but without any barrier between the receiver and the keyboard. Ideally, the RF

receiver should be connected to USB slot in front of the CPU for smooth performance. This feature is great for users having HTPCs as it eases controlling the system or browsing the web while watching a movie or while making presentations on big screens in executive offices or in boardrooms. The absence of a dedicated number pad makes mathematical calculations an uphill task.

It takes a while getting accustomed to using the trackball with a finger. The placement of the mouse click buttons and the scroll key just below the trackball is inconvenient. The two additional click buttons on the left-hand side of the keyboard provide immense flexibility. Power saving mode of the keyboard is an interesting feature, which takes the keyboard to a sleep mode if it's not used for over 4 minutes. It exits the sleep mode as soon as any key is pressed. A light above the trackball blinks when the battery is running out.

A retail price of Rs. 2,995 is a bit on the steeper side.

Specifications

2.4 GHz RF, mouse speed 800 dpi, Power source - 2 AAA batteries, Minimum RAM - 256 MB, USB port 1.1 or later, Works on Windows 98/Me/2000/XP/Vista/Win 7, Linux, OS X
Dimensions: 365x 156 x 22 mm

Contact

Amkette

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Web: www.amkette.com

Price: Rs. 2,995



6.5/10

Features..... 6.5
Performance7
Build quality.....7
Value for money.....6

HP TouchSmart PC IQ528d

Touch me not?

Specifications

Processor: Intel C2 Duo T6600, Memory: 4 GB
Graphics: GeForce 9300M GS
HDD: 640 GB SATA
TV: PCIe mini-card,
TV tuner card

Contact

HP India

Email: ketan.patel@hp.com

Web: www.hp.com

Price: Rs. 89,990

This all-in-one offering from HP is not your ordinary run-of-the-mill PC. This sleek device is more a gadget than a PC and features a 22-inch touchscreen. This means you get to interact with it in more

ways than just your mouse and keyboard. The piece we got had Windows 7 and a set of touch applications that form part of the TouchPack.

While it gets full points for coolness, touch becomes cumbersome when used as your primary method of input. Issues such as arm fatigue and finger prints on the screen do creep up. The build quality is solid – the wireless keyboard features pseudo isolated keys, while the mouse looks surprisingly like the magic mouse from Apple.

It also comes with an MCE remote, so you can

operate it from a few feet away. There is slot loading dual layer DVD writer optical drive on the side. Of course a hoard of ports lie underneath a removable panel at the back, including LAN, SPDIF and TVin. The audio quality of the speakers is quite decent, very suitable for personal listening.

As for the internals, it features Intel's Core 2 Duo T6600 2.20 GHz processor with 4 GB of RAM. The GeForce 9300M GS graphics solution is more than enough for running touch apps and playing HD video. However, serious gaming is out of the question. Our standard benchmarks for PCs revealed a decent performance. It's overpriced but if you want a conversation piece you might want to opt for it.



6.5/10

Features.....7
Performance6.5
Build quality.....7
Value for money.....5